

Money doesn't buy swag

Channel: Tim Luong · Published: Aug 07, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/1DjV39Mj6jE> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Tim Luong makes the case that real swag has nothing to do with how much you spend — proven live by someone who pulled together a sharp meeting outfit for under \$23 from a thrift store and a street vendor.

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The Salvation Army Shirt Story 0:00

- Tim opens by calling out the crowd directly: "You guys are spending too much on your swag."
- A person in the group shares their story as a live example:
 - Had a sleepover two nights prior
 - Had to go straight from the sleepover to a meeting
 - Couldn't wear the shirt they slept in
 - Stopped at a Salvation Army and bought a replacement shirt for **\$12.99**
- The reaction from the group is immediate shock and disbelief ("Get out," "It's a penalty")
- Tim flips the reaction — treating it as proof of the point, not an embarrassment

The \$10 Street Glasses 0:00

- Someone in the group asks about the glasses, noting they also look good
- The glasses were bought off a New York street vendor for **\$10**
- Total outfit cost: roughly **\$22.99** — shirt plus glasses

The Takeaway 0:00

- The core argument is demonstrated rather than lectured: a meeting-ready, complimented outfit assembled for under \$23
- Swag is framed as confidence and aesthetic instinct, not price tags
- Thrift stores and street vendors are presented as legitimate, even impressive, sourcing options

- The group's shocked reaction (treating cheap clothes as a "penalty") is implicitly the mindset Tim is pushing back against